developments within Tibet and to Chinese perception of a change in India's handling of Tibetan issues. The increasing influence of Tibetans abroad may have caused protests within Tibet that subsequently led to riots in March 2008. Also in 2008, in talks with Beijing, the Dalai Lama insisted on autonomy not just for the Tibet Autonomous Region but also 'Greater Tibet' which includes large parts of other provinces. Before and during the Beijing Olympics, China saw evidence of an overseas Tibetan attempt to embarrass it in front of the world. Before this, China had noticed a change in Delhi's handling of Tibet. In 2005, India upgraded formal contacts with the Tibetan exile community, including having the Foreign Secretary meet the Dalai Lama. Jha notes that China may have been particularly sensitive to these upgraded contacts since they occurred just after Premier Wen Jiabao had visited India, had signed the 2005 deal on the basic principles of a border settlement, and had announced China's recognition of Sikkim as part of India.[116]

Mohan Malik, a specialist on India–China relations, offers an alternative set of perspectives based on his reading of Chinese sources between 2006 and 2009. One view among Chinese experts was that Arunachal Pradesh is simply too large to give up completely, 'equivalent to two and a half Taiwans and as large as Jiangsu province'. A second view was that the Chinese leadership at the time had no one of the stature of Mao or Deng. Making concessions to India would be virtually impossible for their less powerful successors. A third view was that Arunachal Pradesh was a resource-rich region and could not therefore be given away. Fourth, China was outstripping India in terms of comprehensive national power: why then should it concede anything? A final perspective was that a harder stand on Arunachal Pradesh could exert pressure on India to give up Tawang, which is a vital centre of Tibetan Buddhism.[117]

At any rate, whatever the reasons for Beijing's hardening stand from 2006 onward, India and China once again drifted apart on Tibet to the point that, as shown earlier, Delhi stopped affirming its recognition of Chinese sovereignty over the province. No joint statement since then has mentioned Tibet. From May 2014, with Modi's coming to power, differences over